
Advisor: Bernardo Guimarães

Conditional Cash Transfers as Stabilization Tool: a HANK Approach

1. Model

The setup is a standard New Keynesian model with incomplete markets and labor supply risk. Time is discrete and runs from $t = 0$ to infinity. There are four types of agents in the economy: households, firms, labor unions, and the government.

Households are heterogeneous (Aiyagari 1994), workers and firms join in a formal-informal setup, and the rest of the economy follows the textbook New Keynesian model (Galí 2015). There is no aggregate uncertainty and the economy starts in the deterministic steady-state.

Households

Assume there exists a continuum $i \in [0, 1]$ of ex-ante identical households, but experiencing idiosyncratic shocks in labor productivity and discount factor.

Households enjoy a CRRA-GHH utility over consumption $c_{i,t}$ and worked hours $h_{i,t}$ (Greenwood, Hercowitz, and Huffman 1988)¹, which we define $u(\tilde{c}_{i,t}) = u(c_{i,t} - v(h_{i,t}))$ as

$$\max_{c_{i,t}, h_{i,t}} \mathbb{E}_0 \left[\sum_{t=0}^{\infty} \beta^t \frac{\tilde{c}_{i,t}^{1-\frac{1}{\gamma}}}{1-\frac{1}{\gamma}} \right], \quad \text{with } v(h) = \psi \frac{h^{1+\frac{1}{\varphi}}}{1+\frac{1}{\varphi}}$$

where γ is the elasticity of intertemporal substitution (EIS) and φ is the Frisch elasticity of labor supply.

A household faces idiosyncratic labor productivity shocks $e_{i,t}$ with $\mathbb{E}[e_{i,t}] = 1$, and discount factor heterogeneity $\beta_i \in \{\beta_L, \beta_H\}$, where there is ω_I impatient households. They can work in the formal or informal sector, or be unemployed $s \in \{F, I, U\}$. Each sector has a specific productivity $\theta_{i,t}^s$, re-drawn on each new offer.

Formal workers earn labor income $(1 - \tau_\ell)\theta_{i,t}^F w_t e_{i,t} h_{i,t}$, where w_t is the formal wage rate and τ_ℓ is a fixed labor income tax rate. While, informal workers receive benefits $\theta_{i,t}^I w_t^I e_{i,t} h_{i,t}$,

¹The GHH specification assumes zero income effect, so that the hours decision is separable from the consumption-savings problem.

where $w_t^I = \xi w_t$ and $\xi \in (0, 1)$ is the wage gap. Let $y_t(s, e)$ be this non-financial income,

$$y_t(s, e, \theta) = \begin{cases} (1 - \tau_t)\theta^F w_t h_t e, & \text{if formal;} \\ \theta^I w_t^I h_t e + T_t \cdot \mathbb{1}[\text{eligible}], & \text{if informal;} \\ T_t, & \text{if unemployed.} \end{cases}$$

We assume that formal wages are observable by the government, so that only informal workers and unemployed may be eligible to receive *Bolsa Família* (BF). We assume that informal households are eligible if $y_{i,t}(I, e, \theta) < \bar{y}$ and that the total benefit size is BF_t .

Households save into liquid assets $a_{i,t}$ with ex-ante real return $1 + r_t = (1 + i_{t-1})/(1 + \pi_t)$, where i_t represents the nominal interest rate and π_t denotes inflation. They also receive dividends $d_{i,t}$ from firms, which we assume to be proportional to productivity $d_{i,t} = d_t \cdot e_{i,t}$ ². Their budget constraint at time t reads:

$$c_{i,t} + a_{i,t} = (1 + r_t)a_{i,t-1} + d_{i,t} + y_{i,t}(s, e).$$

Incomplete markets impose a borrowing constraint $a_{i,t} \geq \underline{a}$. Frictions in the labor market imply formal households delegate their labor supply decisions to labor unions, and thus take worked hours as given. While, informal ones choose hours to maximize their utility, thus, for each i ,

$$\psi(h)^{1/\varphi} = \theta w^I e \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad h^I(e) = \left[\frac{\theta w^I e}{\psi} \right]^\varphi.$$

This generates a productivity cutoff for informal workers of

$$\theta w^I e \left(\frac{\theta w^I e}{\psi} \right)^\varphi < \bar{y} \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad e < e^* = \frac{(\psi^\varphi \bar{y})^{\frac{1}{1+\varphi}}}{\theta w^I}.$$

Such as Esteban-Pretel and Kitao (2021) and Finamor (2025), given a sector s , we assume that each worker faces an exogenous layoff probability δ_s , and receives an offer from s with probability π_s . The worker accepts the offer with the higher value, smoothed by additive idiosyncratic preference shocks explained later.

²Dividends are proportional to productivity in order to increase inequality. We aim to perform robustness tests with other specifications.

The Bellman Equation for each individual i in sector $s \in \{F, I\}$ is

$$\begin{aligned}
V_t^s(a, e, \beta, \theta) = \max_{\tilde{c}, a'} & \left\{ \frac{\tilde{c}^{1-\frac{1}{\gamma}}}{1-\frac{1}{\gamma}} + \beta \mathbb{E}_t \left[\delta_s V_{t+1}^U(\cdot) + (1-\delta_s) \left(\right. \right. \right. \\
& \pi_F (1-\pi_I) \max \{ V_{t+1}^s(\cdot, \theta), V_{t+1}^F(\cdot, \theta') \} \\
& + (1-\pi_F) \pi_I \max \{ V_{t+1}^s(\cdot, \theta), V_{t+1}^I(\cdot, \theta') \} \\
& + \pi_F \pi_I \max \{ V_{t+1}^s(\cdot, \theta), V_{t+1}^I(\cdot, \theta'), V_{t+1}^F(\cdot, \theta') \} \\
& \left. \left. \left. + (1-\pi_F)(1-\pi_I) V_{t+1}^s(\cdot, \theta) \right) \right] \right\} \\
\text{s.t.} \quad & c + a' = (1+r_t)a + y_t(s, e, \theta) + d_{i,t} \\
& a' \in [\underline{a}, \infty), \quad \tilde{c} = c - v(h),
\end{aligned}$$

and for each unemployed worker is

$$\begin{aligned}
V_t^U(a, \beta) = \max_{c, a'} & \left\{ \frac{c^{1-\frac{1}{\gamma}}}{1-\frac{1}{\gamma}} + \beta \mathbb{E}_t \left[(1-\pi_F)(1-\pi_I) V_{t+1}^U(\cdot) \right. \right. \\
& + \pi_F (1-\pi_I) \max \{ V_{t+1}^U(\cdot), V_{t+1}^F(\cdot) \} \\
& + (1-\pi_F) \pi_I \max \{ V_{t+1}^U(\cdot), V_{t+1}^I(\cdot) \} \\
& \left. \left. + \pi_F \pi_I \max \{ V_{t+1}^U(\cdot), V_{t+1}^I(\cdot), V_{t+1}^F(\cdot) \} \right] \right\} \\
\text{s.t.} \quad & c + a' = (1+r_t)a + y_t(U) + d_{i,t} \\
& a' \in [\underline{a}, \infty).
\end{aligned}$$

Formal workers maximize their utility taking hours as given, so their labor disutility is internalized at the union level, not by individual households. However, informal hours are chosen and therefore included in the Euler Equation. Given their decision, their consumption-equivalent income is

$$w^I e h_t - v(h_t) = w^I e h_t - \psi \frac{h_{i,t} h_{i,t}^{1/\varphi}}{1 + \frac{1}{\varphi}} = \frac{w^I e h_t}{1 + \varphi}.$$

As in Caliendo, Dvorkin, and Parro (2019), before deciding, the households receive an offer $A \in \{F, I, FI\}$ and draws a vector $\{\varepsilon^j\}$ over the options $j \in \mathcal{S}$, with scale σ_S ³, and picks the option j maximizing $V^j + \varepsilon^j$. This delivers a closed-form expected value,

$$\mathbb{P}^A(j) = \frac{\exp(V^j/\sigma_S)}{\sum_{k \in \mathcal{S}} \exp(V^k/\sigma_S)}, \quad \mathbb{E} \left[\max_{j \in \mathcal{S}} \{V^j + \varepsilon^j\} \right] = \sigma_S \ln \sum_{j \in \mathcal{S}} \exp(V^j/\sigma_S)^4.$$

³ σ_S governs the smoothness of the decision. As $\sigma_S \rightarrow 0$ it collapses to the deterministic max.

⁴We use a standard linear weighted approximation for the log-exp sum.

These shocks render the transition a differentiable function, which allows it to be linearized when computing the sequence-space Jacobians, as in Iskhakov et al. (2017). Therefore, the sector transition matrix $\Pi_t^s = \mathbb{P}(s'|s)$ is given by

$$\Pi_t^s = \begin{bmatrix} (1 - \delta_F)\phi_F(F) & (1 - \delta_F)\phi_F(I) & \delta_F \\ (1 - \delta_I)\phi_I(F) & (1 - \delta_I)\phi_I(I) & \delta_I \\ \phi_U(F) & \phi_U(I) & \phi_U(U) \end{bmatrix},$$

where $\phi_s(s')$ is the probability of accepting an offer s' given that the worker is in sector s ,

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_F(I) &= \pi_F \pi_I \mathbb{P}^{FI}(I) + (1 - \pi_F) \pi_I \mathbb{P}^I(I), & \phi_F(F) &= 1 - \phi_F(I), \\ \phi_I(F) &= \pi_F \pi_I \mathbb{P}^{FI}(F) + \pi_F (1 - \pi_I) \mathbb{P}^F(F), & \phi_I(I) &= 1 - \phi_I(F), \\ \phi_U(F) &= \pi_F \pi_I \mathbb{P}^{FI}(F) + \pi_F (1 - \pi_I) \mathbb{P}^F(F), \\ \phi_U(I) &= \pi_F \pi_I \mathbb{P}^{FI}(I) + (1 - \pi_F) \pi_I \mathbb{P}^I(I), & \phi_U(U) &= 1 - \phi_U(F) - \phi_U(I). \end{aligned}$$

Firms

In the firm side, there is a representative final-good producer that aggregates a continuum of $j \in [0, 1]$ intermediate inputs produced by formal firms,

$$Y_t = \left(\int_0^1 y_{j,t}^{\frac{\varepsilon-1}{\varepsilon}} dj \right)^{\frac{\varepsilon}{\varepsilon-1}},$$

where $\varepsilon > 0$ is a constant substitution elasticity (CES).

Each intermediate good j is produced by a monopolistic competitive firm $y_{j,t} = Z_t l_{j,t}$. They hire labor at real wage w_t and set a constant markup of $\mu = \frac{\varepsilon}{\varepsilon-1}$. Hence, $P_t = \mu Z_t W_t$, and the real wage equals $w_t = Z_t / \mu$ at every date in steady-state. Firms' dividends are taxed at the same rate τ_ℓ as labor income, so $d_t = (1 - \tau_\ell)(Y_t - w_t L_t)$, where $L_t = \mathbb{E}[l_{j,t}]$ is the aggregate formal labor.

We assume sticky prices following Rotemberg (1982), standard in Neo-Keynesian's literature. Such as Hagedorn, Manovskii, and Mitman (2019), the Phillips curve for price inflation is given by

$$\ln(1 + \pi_t) = \kappa \left[\frac{w_t}{Z_t} - \frac{1}{\mu} \right] + \frac{\ln(1 + \pi_{t+1})}{1 + r_{t+1}} \cdot \frac{Y_{t+1}}{Y_t},$$

Additionally, there is a representative informal firm operating in a perfectly competitive market and producing under constant returns to scale, so $Y_t^I = w_t^I L_t^I$. The steady-state wage gap $\xi = w_t^I / w_t$ is calibrated to match *PNAD Contínua* data.

Unions

Nominal wages are assumed to be sticky as in Erceg, Henderson, and Levin (2000), where unions set nominal wages to maximize agent utility subject to Rotemberg (1982)'s adjustment costs. We assume that unions allocate all formal labor hours uniformly across agents, so $h_{i,t} = h_t$ (Auclert, Rognlie, and Straub 2025).

Also, as in Hagedorn, Manovskii, and Mitman (2019), union's objective is to maximize the utility of an agent with average consumption $\bar{C}_t = \int_0^1 c_{it} di$, discounted by the average discount factor $\bar{\beta} = \lambda_I \beta_L + (1 - \lambda_I) \beta_H$ (Auclert, Rognlie, Souchier, et al. 2021). This results in a Phillips curve for wage inflation $\pi_t^w = (1 + \pi_t)w_t/w_{t-1}$ given by

$$\ln(1 + \pi_t^w) = \kappa_w \left[\psi \cdot h_t^{1/\varphi} \cdot \tilde{C}_t^{1/\gamma} - \frac{(1 - \tau_\ell)w_t L_t}{\mu_w} \right] + \bar{\beta} \ln(1 + \pi_{t+1}^w).$$

The Phillips Curve calculations for price and wage are found in the Appendix.

Government

Monetary Policy follows a standard lagged Taylor Rule, without microfoundations and only with an inflation target, $i_t = r_{t-1}^* + \phi \pi_{t-1}$, where r^* is the neutral real interest rate, and $\phi > 1$ (Taylor 1993).

In the governmental sphere, we have a government that purchase public goods, collects taxes, makes transfers, and incurs debt; therefore, the government's budget constraint is characterized by

$$G_t + T_t \cdot \text{BF}_t + (1 + r_t)B_{t-1} = B_t + \tau_t Y_t,$$

which means that, in steady-state, $G = \tau w L - r B - T \cdot \text{BF}$.

For dynamic simulations, we intend to apply two regimes: one financed by debt, with T fixed and $B_t = (1 + r)B + T \cdot \text{BF} - \tau w L - G$, and another financed by taxes with B fixed and T variable. For now, we consider fixed T_t and B_t , treated as exogenous, with G_t adjusting to it.

Market Clearing

Finally, the asset, labor, and goods markets reach equilibrium (Market Clearing Conditions). We define $\Lambda_t(s, \beta, e, a)$ as the household distribution over a given period of time. First, the asset market reaches equilibrium when household savings equal government bonds

$$A_t = \int a_{i,t} d\Lambda_t(s, \beta, e, a) = B_t;$$

the labor market clears when the share of employment in the workforce equals the firm's demand for labor

$$\begin{aligned} L_t &= \int \mathbb{1}\{s_{i,t} = F\} \cdot \theta_{i,t}^F \cdot e_{i,t} \cdot h_{i,t} d\Lambda_t(s, \beta, e, a); \\ L_t^I &= \int \mathbb{1}\{s_{i,t} = I\} \cdot \theta_{i,t}^I \cdot e_{i,t} \cdot h_{i,t} d\Lambda_t(s, \beta, e, a); \\ \text{and} \quad F_t + I_t + U_t &= 1; \end{aligned}$$

the BF benefit clears when it is given to the eligible households

$$\text{BF}_t = U_t + \int \mathbb{1}\{s_{i,t} = I, e_{i,t} < e^*\} d\Lambda(s, \beta, e, a);$$

and the goods market clear when $Y + Y^I = C + G$ in the steady-state. However, due to the GHH utility, we have $C = \tilde{C} + \int v(h) d\Lambda_t(\cdot)$ and

$$\int \psi \frac{h_{i,t}^{1+\frac{1}{\varphi}}}{1+\frac{1}{\varphi}} d\Lambda_t(s, \beta, e, a) = \int \frac{\varphi h_{i,t} w_t^I e_{i,t}}{1+\varphi} d\Lambda_t(s, \beta, e, a) = \frac{\varphi w_t^I L_t^I}{1+\varphi} = \frac{\varphi}{1+\varphi} Y_t^I.$$

Thus,

$$Y_t + Y_t^I = \int \tilde{c}_{i,t} d\Lambda_t(s, \beta, e, a) + G_t = \tilde{C}_t + \frac{\varphi}{1+\varphi} Y_t^I + G_t.$$

2. Calibration

Data

To calibrate this model, we use Brazilian data and standard parameters in HANK Literature. Most of the data refers to their average values in 2025.

The labor market moments were obtained in *Pesquisa Nacional por Amostra de Domicílio Contínua* (PNAD-C), an annual survey reporting formality status, wages, weekly worked hours, etc. This panel is interesting to match mainly the sector sizes and the worked hours, for both formal and informal households. However, since it is a survey, it might have under-reporting of informal firms.

Some general macroeconomic measures were also used, such as the Government Debt (in the Brazilian National Treasury), the interest rates, and the inflation, available in the *Índice Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística* (IBGE). The Gini coefficient of wealth was obtained from the 2025 Global Wealth Report, from UBS. *Bolsa Família* data is available in *Cadastro Único* (CadÚnico), a platform with several statistics about the benefit.

In the future, we aim to gather information also in the *Relação Anual de Informações Sociais* (RAIS), a mandatory annual reporting of firms, but without informality information and only up to 2003, and *Economia Informal Urbana* (ECINF), a survey conducted by IBGE that focus on small business, specially informal ones.

Methods

The main method is the Sequence-Space Jacobian (SSJ) (Auclert, Bardóczy, et al. 2021), with the Endogenous Grid Method (EGM) (Carroll 2006) to solve the heterogeneity. The EGM was combined with the discrete choice among sectors using Iskhakov et al. (2017).

The central idea of SSJ is to summarize the entire model by a matrix equation $\mathbf{F}_t(\mathbf{X}, \mathbf{Z}) = \mathbf{0}$, where $\mathbf{X}$ are the endogenous variables and $\mathbf{Z}$ are the exogenous ones. The Implicit Function Theorem allows us to differentiate this system and obtain General Equilibrium Jacobians, written as

$$d\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{G} d\mathbf{Z} = -\mathbf{F}_{\mathbf{X}}^{-1} \mathbf{F}_{\mathbf{Z}} d\mathbf{Z}.$$

For each shock in *Bolsa Família*, we can compute the Jacobian $dC = \mathbf{G}_{C,T} dT$ of the change in the conditional transfer on household consumption. The Jacobian is computed by perturbing the exogenous variable T and solving the model for the new equilibrium, then calculating the change in consumption C .

Further, we can compute the consumption response to a monetary shock $dC = \mathbf{G}_{C,i} di$ in the presence of the transfer, and compare it to the counterfactual. We measure the stabilization effect of the transfer as the difference between the response in the economy with the program and in the $T = 0$ counterfactual,

$$\text{Stab}(T) = dC \Big|_{T>0} - dC \Big|_{T=0},$$

read either as an impulse response or as the induced change in the volatility of consumption $\Delta \text{Var}(C_t)$, a program that smooths fluctuations delivers $\Delta \text{Var}(C_t) < 0$. This effect can be decomposed in a insurance and a composition channel,

$$d\mathbf{X} = d\mathbf{X}^{\text{ins}} + (d\mathbf{X} - d\mathbf{X}^{\text{ins}}) = \mathbf{G}^{\text{ins}} d\mathbf{Z} + (\mathbf{G} - \mathbf{G}^{\text{ins}}) d\mathbf{Z}.$$

The sectoral block of the transition matrix Π_t is endogenous and depends on the continuation values, $\Pi_t = \Pi(\mathbf{V}_t, \Lambda_t)$, where $\mathbf{V}_t = (V_t^F, V_t^I, V_t^U)$. The household's distribution evolves by combining the asset policy with the Markov transition over the states, $\Lambda_{t+1} = \mathcal{T}(\Pi_t, a_t(s, \theta, \beta, e))$. To solve the steady-state distribution, we iterate until Π_t converges to its fixed point, analogue to Aguirregabiria and Mira (2007).

The insurance channel is captured by the frozen- Π . Holding sectoral sorting fixed, the transfer relaxes the budget of unemployed and low-income informal households, and, since these are high-MPC, it dampens the aggregate response (Auclert, Rognlie, and Straub 2024).

The composition channel is captured by the moving- Π Jacobian, because the CCT raises the value of informality relative to formal work, so workers are tilted toward the

informal sector, which is riskier. The insurance term is stabilizing, while the composition is potentially destabilizing. The sign and magnitude of the net effect are the quantitative answer to our question.

Letting the transition respond, $d\Pi_t = \Pi_{\mathbf{V}} d\mathbf{V}_t$, yields the general equilibrium Jacobian $\mathbf{G}$. This dynamic is obtained as the dynamic analogue of the steady-state: given a shock path, we iterate so that households' sectoral choices are consistent with the values those very choices generate along the transition (Auclert, Bardóczy, et al. 2021).

Calibration

Table 1: External Calibration

Description		Value	Source
<i>Households</i>			
γ	EIS	0.5	Standard in Literature
δ_β	Difference: $\beta_H - \beta_L$	0.12	Approximate Gini Coefficient
ω_I	Share of Impatient Agents	0.50	Auclert, Rognlie, and Straub (2025)
<i>Productivity and Asset Grid</i>			
$\underline{a}$	Borrowing constraint	0.0	No Borrowing (McKay and Reis 2016)
$\bar{a}$	Maximum asset	200	Sufficient to cover the top of dist.
N_a	Number of Asset Grid	200	Accuracy near constraint
ρ_e	Persistence of Log-Productivity	0.966	Kaplan, Moll, and Violante (2018)
σ_e	Productivity Std. Dev.	0.85	Bartal and Becard (2024)
N_e	Number of Nodes	15	Standard Discretization
μ_F, μ_I	Sector Average Productivity	0.0, -0.2	Standard Differentiation
σ_F, σ_I	Sector Std. Dev. Productivity	0.2, 0.4	Standard Differentiation
N_θ	Number of Nodes	3	Standard Discretization
<i>Firms</i>			
Y	Aggregate Output	1.0	Normalization
ξ	Wage gap = w^I/w	0.64	PNAD-C Data
μ	Price Markup	1.11	Basu and Fernald (1997)
μ_w	Price Markup	1.11	Equal to μ
κ	Price-NKPC Slope	0.025	Hazell et al. (2022)
κ_w	Wage-NKPC slope	0.025	Equal to κ
<i>Government and Monetary Policy</i>			
r^*	Neutral Real Interest Rate	1.0%	4% annual average
ϕ	Taylor Rule Coefficient	1.5	Standard (Taylor 1993)
τ_ℓ	Labor Income Tax Rate	0.27	Average Tax Payroll in Brazil
T/w	Bolsa Família Transfer	0.14	CadÚnico, PNAD-C

Each model period stands for one quarter and the computational time horizon is 100 quarters (or 25 years). We solve the steady-state equilibrium computationally by Brent's method, internally calibrating parameters to clear the asset market, the labor market, the government budget constraint, and the Phillips curves. The external calibration is shown

Table 2: Endogenous Calibration

Description		Value	Target	Model	Data	Source
<i>Households</i>						
ψ	Disutility of Labor	0.42	h_F	1.0	1.0	Normalization
φ	Frisch Elasticity	0.15	$\mathbb{E}(h_I)$	0.89	0.87	PNAD-C Data
β_H	Patient's Discount Factor	0.971	B/Y	3.2	3.2	Tesouro Nacional
<i>Labor market</i>						
π_F	Formal Offer Probability	0.10	F	44.5%	50.0%	PNAD-C Data
π_I	Informal Offer Probability	0.30	I	40.2%	44.2%	PNAD-C Data
δ_F, δ_I	Layoff Probabilities	0.03, 0.10	U	15.4%	5.8%	PNAD-C Data
$\bar{y}$	Bolsa Família Threshold	0.6	BF	0.433	0.294	CadÚnico, PNAD-C

in table 1 and the endogenous calibration is in 2. The goods market was left untargeted to verify the Walras' Law.

The idiosyncratic productivity follows a log-normal $AR(1)$ process, $\ln e' = \rho_e \ln e + \varepsilon^e$, with $\varepsilon^e \sim N(0, \sigma_e^2)$. This is approximated by a finite Markov chain with N_e grid points (Rouwenhorst 1995). We also assume a log-spaced grid for assets and a log-normal sector productivity grid $\ln \theta^s \sim N(\mu_s, \sigma_s^2)$, that is discretized by a Gauss-Hermite quadrature with N_θ nodes (Meghir, Narita, and Robin 2015).

Each household has a $q = 0.10$ probability of drawing a discount factor (β_L, β_H) , corresponding to an average type duration of 25 years, used to capture a generation (Auclert, Rognlie, and Straub 2025). This aims to capture similar results in relation to a life-cycle overlapping generations with permanent ability shock model.

In the household preferences, elasticity of intertemporal substitution is standard in literature $\gamma = 0.5$ ⁵.

The output is normalized $Y = 1.0$ and we defined $\mu = 1.11$, which is standard in the HANK literature (Kaplan, Moll, and Violante 2018; Auclert, Rognlie, and Straub 2025)⁶, and $\kappa = \kappa_w = 0.025$, consistent with Hazell et al. (2022) estimates.

Taylor Rule is pretty standard, with $\phi = 1.5$ and $r^* = 1\%$, consistent with a 4% annual real interest rate for Brazilian economy (Santos and Muinhos 2024). The Government debt is set to 80% of yearly GDP, consistent with Brazilian National Treasury data. Wage tax is an average of all contributions levied on the payroll, $\tau_\ell = 0.27$.

The *Bolsa Família* statistics were obtained from the Cadastro Único⁷, where we calibrated the T/w ratio in steady-state to be equal to the data from the Brazilian economy, where $T = \text{R\$ } 600$ and $w = \text{R\$ } 4,294$. We also calibrated the *Bolsa Família* threshold $\bar{y}$ to match the actual size of the program⁸.

⁵EIS $\gamma = 0.5$ is consistent with micro estimates surveyed by Valickova, Havranek, and Horvath (2015).

⁶Markup $\mu = 1.11$ is also consistent with the estimates of Basu and Fernald (1997).

⁷Available in VIS DATA 3 and Cadastro Único.

⁸We used the average household size in PNAD-C to calculate a percentage estimate of the program.

3. Results

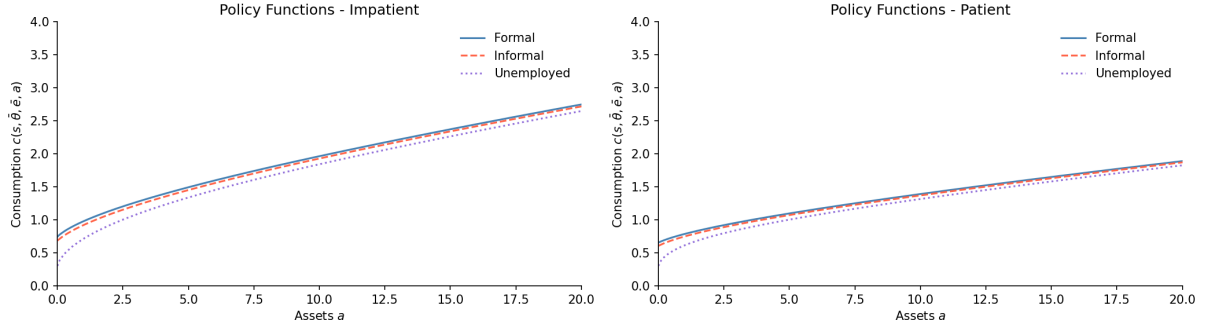


Figure 1: Steady-State Consumption Policy Function

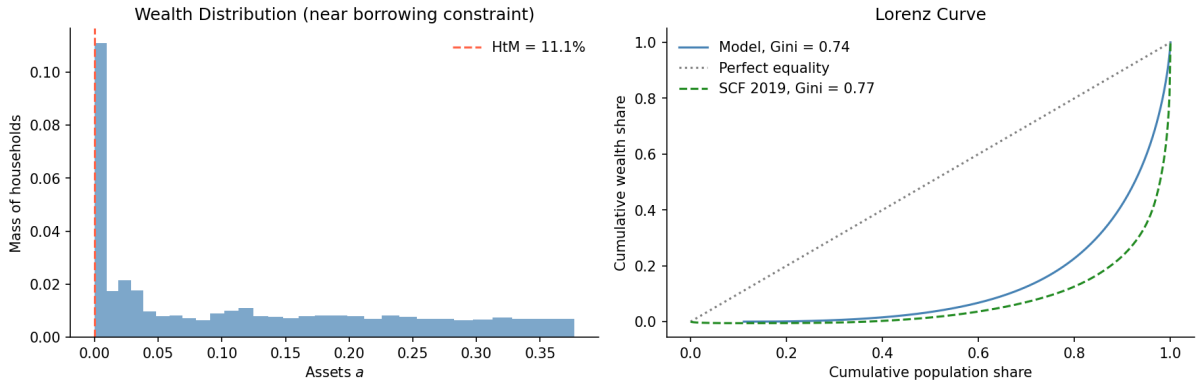


Figure 2: Wealth Distribution

Table 3: Steady state: Bolsa Família vs. No-Transfer Counterfactual

	With BF	No BF	Δ
Formal share α_F	44.5%	74.7%	-30.3
Informal share α_I	40.2%	15.0%	+25.2
Unemployment U	15.4%	10.3%	+5.1
Hand-to-Mouth	11.1%	0.4%	+10.7
Wealth Gini	0.742	0.611	+0.131
Consumption Gini	0.399	0.446	-0.047
Aggregate Consumption C	1.227	0.880	+0.348
BF spending	0.109	0.000	+0.109
Welfare $\mathbb{E}[V]$	-18.380	-29.697	+11.317

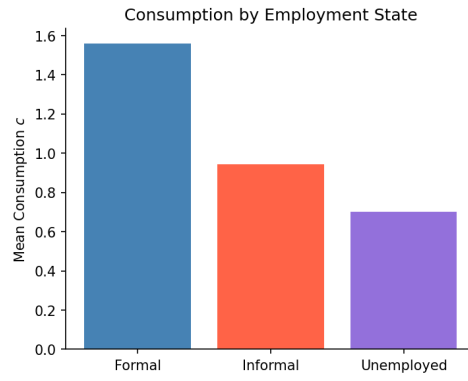


Figure 3: Steady-State Average Consumption by State

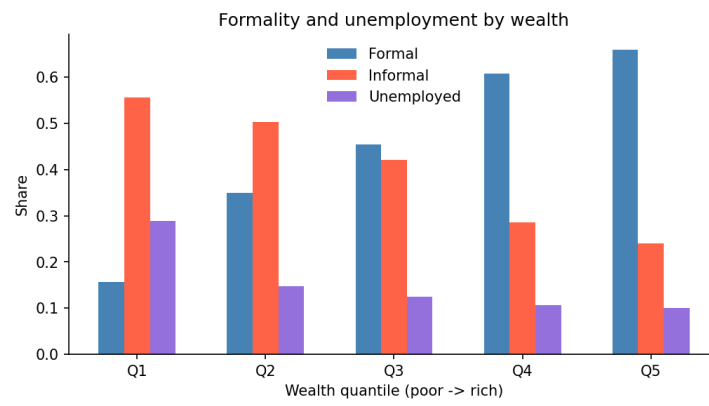


Figure 4: Formality and Unemployment by Wealth

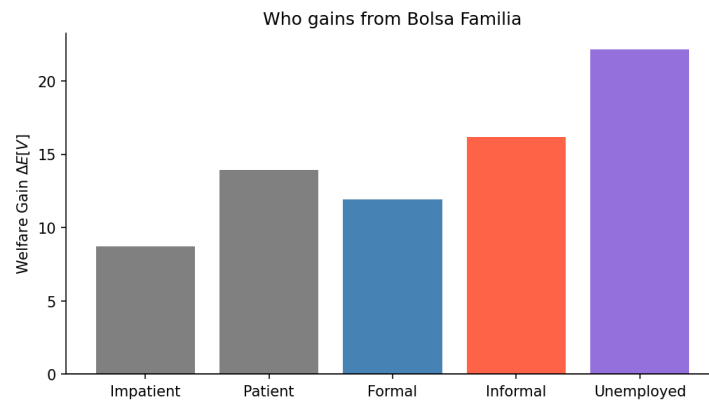


Figure 5: Welfare gains by Type of Household

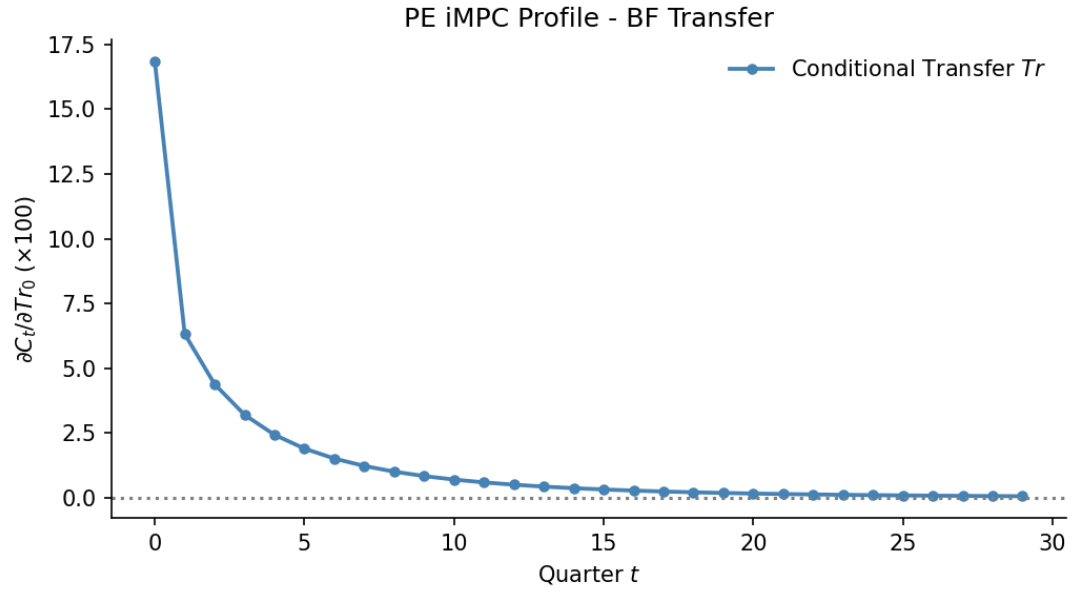


Figure 6: Partial Equilibrium iMPC

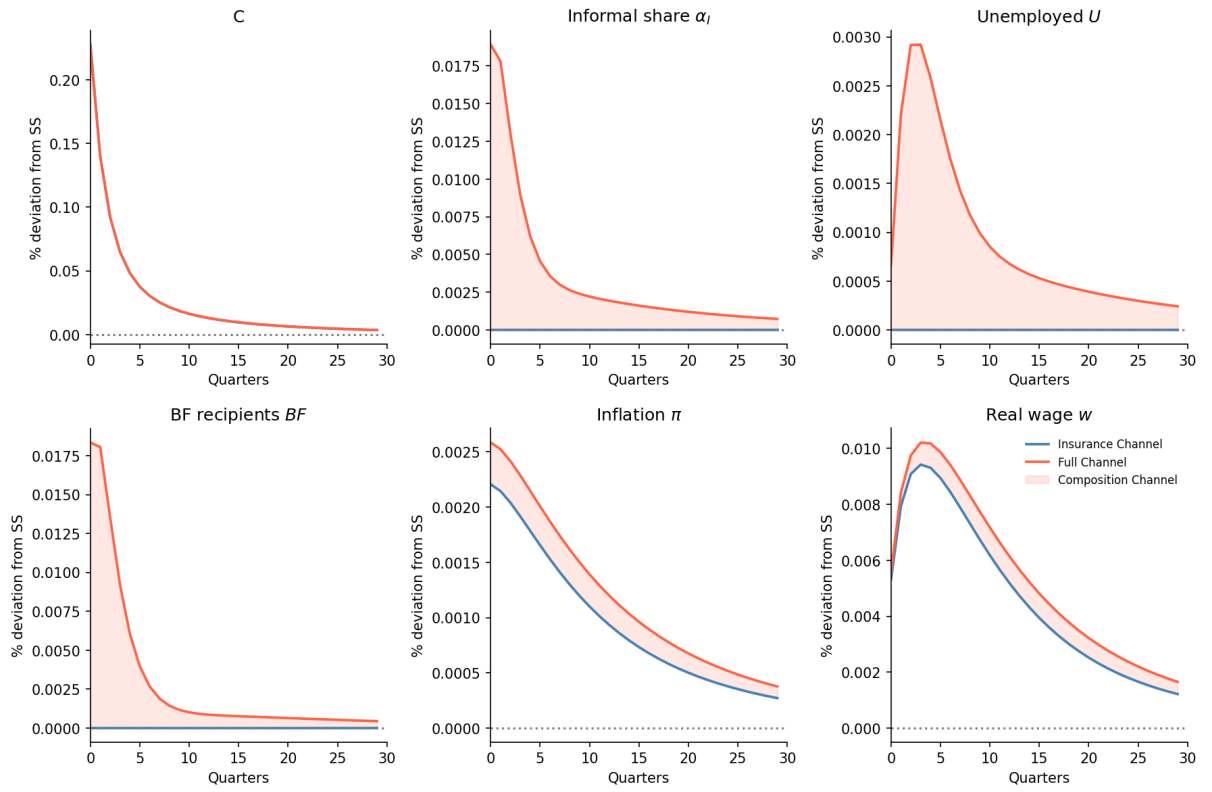


Figure 7: IRFs: Insurance vs Composition Effect (shock in T)

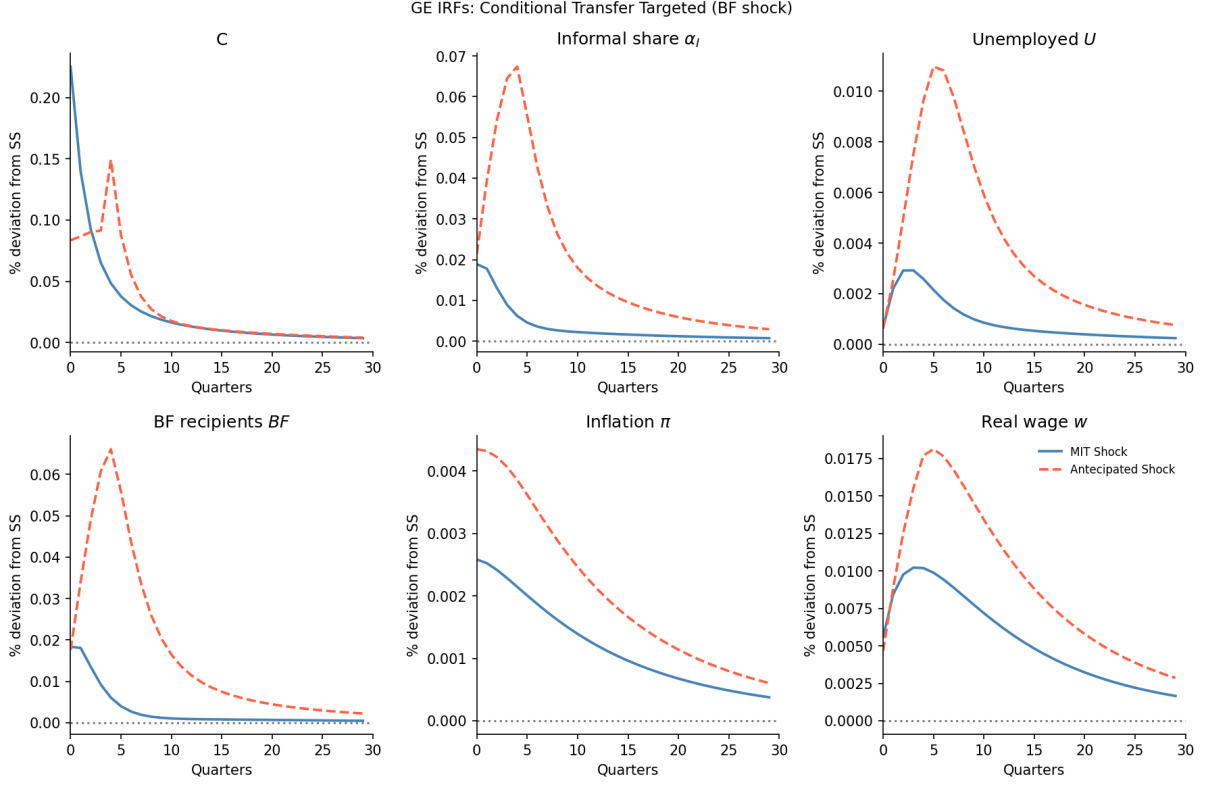


Figure 8: IRFs: MIT vs Anticipated Shock (shock in T)

Table 4: Response in Consumption: Different Horizons

Horizon	Insurance	Full	Composition	Comp. (%)
4	0.0052	0.0052	-0.0000	-0.4
8	0.0067	0.0066	-0.0000	-0.2
20	0.0081	0.0081	-0.0000	-0.0
100	0.0092	0.0092	-0.0000	-0.3

Robustness Tests

Lastly, in order to verify whether this results are representatives and robust, we intent to do some robustness tests changing some calibration parameters, such as γ , δ_β , ω_I , ξ , μ , and κ_w . This parameters might have minor implications in the results, but it is expected that the model continues to have the same results.

Further, since there are several combinations of the sector transition probabilities that implies in the same sector sizes, we aim to changing each of this probability and capture the result. This change will affect the dynamics and may alter the transfer effects, due to a faster or slower transition to the informal sector. If the transition data is feasible in PNAD-C, it will not be necessary.

Also, as we commented early, we intent to perform other dividend specifications instead of $d_{i,t} = d_t \cdot e_{i,t}$. We also aim to change the GHH utility to a standard separable utility in the form of $u(c) - v(h)$, which must have similar results.

References

- Aguirregabiria, Victor and Pedro Mira (2007). “Sequential estimation of dynamic discrete games”. In: *Econometrica* 75.1, pp. 1–53.
- Aiyagari, S Rao (1994). “Uninsured idiosyncratic risk and aggregate saving”. In: *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 109.3, pp. 659–684.
- Auclert, Adrien, Bence Bardóczy, et al. (2021). “Using the sequence-space Jacobian to solve and estimate heterogeneous-agent models”. In: *Econometrica* 89.5, pp. 2375–2408.
- Auclert, Adrien, Matthew Rognlie, Martin Souchier, et al. (2021). *Exchange rates and monetary policy with heterogeneous agents: Sizing up the real income channel*. Tech. rep. National Bureau of Economic Research.
- Auclert, Adrien, Matthew Rognlie, and Ludwig Straub (2024). “The intertemporal keynesian cross”. In: *Journal of Political Economy* 132.12, pp. 4068–4121.
- (2025). “Fiscal and monetary policy with heterogeneous agents”. In: *Annual Review of Economics* 17.
- Bartal, Mehdi and Yvan Becard (2024). “Consumption tax cuts vs stimulus payments”. In: *Journal of Public Economics* 239, p. 105227.
- Basu, Susanto and John G Fernald (1997). “Returns to scale in US production: Estimates and implications”. In: *Journal of political economy* 105.2, pp. 249–283.
- Caliendo, Lorenzo, Maximiliano Dvorkin, and Fernando Parro (2019). “Trade and labor market dynamics: General equilibrium analysis of the china trade shock”. In: *Econometrica* 87.3, pp. 741–835.
- Calvo, Guillermo A (1983). “Staggered prices in a utility-maximizing framework”. In: *Journal of monetary Economics* 12.3, pp. 383–398.
- Carroll, Christopher D (2006). “The method of endogenous gridpoints for solving dynamic stochastic optimization problems”. In: *Economics letters* 91.3, pp. 312–320.
- Erceg, Christopher J, Dale W Henderson, and Andrew T Levin (2000). “Optimal monetary policy with staggered wage and price contracts”. In: *Journal of monetary Economics* 46.2, pp. 281–313.
- Esteban-Pretel, Julien and Sagiri Kitao (2021). “Labor market policies in a dual economy”. In: *Labour Economics* 68, p. 101956.
- Finamor, Lucas (2025). “Labor market informality, risk, and public insurance”. In: *Unpublished manuscript*.
- Galí, Jordi (2015). *Monetary policy, inflation, and the business cycle: an introduction to the new Keynesian framework and its applications*. Princeton University Press.
- Greenwood, Jeremy, Zvi Hercowitz, and Gregory W Huffman (1988). “Investment, capacity utilization, and the real business cycle”. In: *The American Economic Review*, pp. 402–417.
- Hagedorn, Marcus, Iourii Manovskii, and Kurt Mitman (2019). *The fiscal multiplier*. Tech. rep. National Bureau of Economic Research.
- Hazell, Jonathon et al. (2022). “National wage setting”. In: *University of Chicago, Becker Friedman Institute for Economics Working Paper* 2022-150.
- Iskhakov, Fedor et al. (2017). “The endogenous grid method for discrete-continuous dynamic choice models with (or without) taste shocks”. In: *Quantitative Economics* 8.2, pp. 317–365.
- Kaplan, Greg, Benjamin Moll, and Giovanni L Violante (2018). “Monetary policy according to HANK”. In: *American Economic Review* 108.3, pp. 697–743.

- McKay, Alisdair and Ricardo Reis (2016). “The role of automatic stabilizers in the US business cycle”. In: *Econometrica* 84.1, pp. 141–194.
- Meghir, Costas, Renata Narita, and Jean-Marc Robin (2015). “Wages and informality in developing countries”. In: *American Economic Review* 105.4, pp. 1509–1546.
- Rotemberg, Julio J (1982). “Monopolistic price adjustment and aggregate output”. In: *The Review of Economic Studies* 49.4, pp. 517–531.
- Rouwenhorst, K Geert (1995). “Asset pricing implications of equilibrium business cycle models”. In: *Frontiers of business cycle research* 1, pp. 294–330.
- Santos, Felipe Mecchi Garcia dos and Marcelo Kfoury Muinhos (2024). “The Natural Rate of Interest in Brazil: State-space modelling approaches”. In: *Brazilian Review of Finance* 22.4, pp. 95–124.
- Taylor, Charles (1993). “To follow a rule”. In: *Bourdieu: critical perspectives* 6, pp. 45–60.
- Valickova, Petra, Tomas Havranek, and Roman Horvath (2015). “Financial development and economic growth: A meta-analysis”. In: *Journal of economic surveys* 29.3, pp. 506–526.

Appendix

Price Phillips Curve

Let Y_t be the aggregate output of the economy, a CES of the intermediary inputs,

$$Y_t = \left(\int_0^1 y_{j,t}^{\frac{\varepsilon-1}{\varepsilon}} dj \right)^{\frac{\varepsilon}{\varepsilon-1}}.$$

This firm maximizes its output subject to $\int_0^1 p_{i,j} y_{i,j} dj$. The FOC implies that the demand for the intermediate good is given by

$$y_{j,t} = \left(\frac{p_{j,t}}{P_t} \right)^{-\varepsilon} Y_t,$$

where P_t is the equilibrium price of the final good,

$$P_t = \left(\int_0^1 p_{j,t}^{1-\varepsilon} dj \right)^{\frac{1}{1-\varepsilon}}.$$

We assume a Rotemberg (1982) quadratic price adjustment cost given by

$$\frac{\theta_p}{2} \left(\frac{p_{j,t}}{p_{j,t-1}} - \bar{\Pi} \right)^2 Y_t,$$

where $\theta_p = (\varepsilon - 1)/\kappa$ is the adjustment cost multiplier and $\bar{\Pi}$ the steady-state inflation.

Let $\Xi(y)$ be the intermediary firm's cost. Given last period's price $p_{j,t-1}$, the firm chooses this period's price $p_{j,t}$ to maximize the present discounted values of future profits,

$$V_t^{IF}(p_{j,t-1}) = \max_{p_{j,t}} \frac{p_{j,t}}{P_t} y_{j,t} - \Xi(y_{j,t}) - \frac{\theta_p}{2} \left(\frac{p_{j,t}}{p_{j,t-1}} - \bar{\Pi} \right)^2 Y_t + \frac{1}{1+r_{t+1}} V_{t+1}^{IF}(p_{j,t}).$$

We can replace the demand function into this problem, so

$$V_t(p_{j,t-1}) = \max_{p_{j,t}} \frac{p_{j,t}}{P_t} \left(\frac{p_{j,t}}{P_t} \right)^{-\varepsilon} Y_t - \Xi(y_{j,t}) - \frac{\theta_p}{2} \left(\frac{p_{j,t}}{p_{j,t-1}} - \bar{\Pi} \right)^2 Y_t + \frac{1}{1+r_{t+1}} V_{t+1}(p_{j,t}).$$

The FOC with respect to $p_{j,t}$ is

$$(1 - \varepsilon) \left(\frac{p_{j,t}}{P_t} \right)^{-\varepsilon} \frac{Y_t}{P_t} + \varepsilon m c_{j,t} - \theta_p \left(\frac{p_{j,t}}{p_{j,t-1}} - \bar{\Pi} \right) \frac{Y_t}{p_{j,t}} + \frac{1}{1+r_{t+1}} V'_{t+1}(p_{j,t}) = 0,$$

where $m c_t = \partial \Xi / \partial y_{j,t}$, and the envelope condition gives us

$$V'_{t+1} = \theta_p \left(\frac{p_{j,t+1}}{p_{j,t}} - \bar{\Pi} \right) \frac{p_{j,t+1}}{p_{j,t}} \frac{Y_{t+1}}{p_{j,t}}.$$

Thus, taking $p_{j,t} = P_t$ in equilibrium,

$$\theta_p (\pi_t - \bar{\Pi}) \pi_t = \varepsilon \left(m c_t - \frac{\varepsilon - 1}{\varepsilon} \right) + \frac{1}{1+r_{t+1}} \theta_p (\pi_{t+1} - \bar{\Pi}) \pi_{t+1} \frac{Y_{t+1}}{Y_t},$$

where we define the firm's markup as $\mu = \frac{\varepsilon}{\varepsilon-1}$. Linearizing around the steady-state $\pi_t = \bar{\Pi}$,

$$\ln(1 + \pi_t) = \frac{\varepsilon}{\theta_p} \left(mc_t - \frac{1}{\mu} \right) + \frac{1}{1 + r_{t+1}} \ln(1 + \pi_{t+1}) \frac{Y_{t+1}}{Y_t},$$

where $\kappa = \varepsilon/\theta_p$ and $mc_t = w_t/Z_t$. This environment is equivalent to Calvo (1983) in first order around zero inflation.

Wage Phillips Curve

We will use the same setting as Hagedorn, Manovskii, and Mitman (2019), but considering just the formal sector. Assume there is a union that aggregate effective labor input into

$$h_t = \left(\int_0^1 e_{i,t}(h_{i,t})^{\frac{\varepsilon_w-1}{\varepsilon_w}} di \right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_w}{\varepsilon_w-1}},$$

sells households labor services $e_{i,t}h_{i,t}$ at nominal wage $W_{i,t}$ to the labor recruiter, which minimizes costs $\int_0^1 W_{i,t}e_{i,t}h_{i,t} di$, implying a demand of

$$h_{i,t} = \left(\frac{W_{i,t}}{W_t} \right)^{-\varepsilon_w} h_t.$$

The unions sets a nominal wage $\hat{W}_t$ for an effect unit of labor, $W_{i,t} = \hat{W}_t$ to maximize profits subject to Rotemberg (1982)'s wage adjustment costs

$$e_{i,t} \frac{\theta_w}{2} \left(\frac{\hat{W}_t}{\hat{W}_{t-1}} - \bar{\Pi}^w \right)^2 h_t.$$

We assume that the union's wage setting problem is

$$V_t^w = \max_{\hat{W}_t} \int \left[\frac{(1 - \tau_\ell)\hat{W}_t}{P_t} e_{i,t}h_{i,t} - \frac{v(h_{i,t})}{u'(\tilde{C}_t)} - e_{i,t}h_t \frac{\theta_w}{2} \left(\frac{\hat{W}_t}{\hat{W}_{t-1}} - \bar{\Pi}^w \right)^2 \right] d\Lambda + \bar{\beta}V_{t+1}^w.$$

Using the same algebra as the price Phillips curve, assuming that the union allocates the same amount of hours in each worker $h_{i,t} = h_t$, and using $\int_F e_{i,t}d\Lambda = L_t$, it is possible to find that

$$\theta_w(\pi_t^w - \bar{\Pi}^w)\pi_t^w = \varepsilon_w \left[\frac{v'(h_t)}{u'(\tilde{C}_t)} - \frac{\varepsilon_w - 1}{\varepsilon_w} (1 - \tau_\ell)w_t L_t \right] + \bar{\beta}\theta_w(\pi_{t+1}^w - \bar{\Pi}^w)\pi_{t+1}^w \frac{h_{t+1}}{h_t},$$

which we can linearize around the steady state $\pi_t^w = \bar{\Pi}^w$ and take $h_{t+1} = h_t$, since there is no population nor technological growth. Thus,

$$\ln(1 + \pi_t^w) = \frac{\varepsilon_w}{\theta_w} \left[\frac{v'(h_t)}{u'(\tilde{C}_t)} - (1 - \tau_\ell)w_t L_t \frac{\varepsilon_w - 1}{\varepsilon_w} \right] + \bar{\beta} \ln(1 + \pi_{t+1}^w).$$

Therefore, defining $\kappa_w = \varepsilon_w/\theta_w$ and $\mu_w = \varepsilon_w/(\varepsilon_w - 1)$, the wage Phillips curve is

$$\ln(1 + \pi_t^w) = \kappa_w \left[\psi \cdot h_t^{1/\varphi} \cdot \tilde{C}_t^{1/\gamma} - \frac{(1 - \tau_\ell)w_t L_t}{\mu_w} \right] + \bar{\beta} \ln(1 + \pi_{t+1}^w).$$